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# Global Technology & Communications

## Citi's 2025 Global TMT Conference Preview: The Most Important Debates Across Tech & Communications



### CITI'S TAKE

Citi's flagship Global TMT conference is rapidly approaching, a 3-day series from September 3<sup>rd</sup>-5<sup>th</sup>, hosted at the New York Hilton Midtown. We expect to hear from over 260 corporates across keynote presentations, fireside chats, panels, and 1x1 investor meetings. Amid a complex and rapidly changing technological, economic, and regulatory backdrop, we identified 12 key themes we expect to resonate across sessions, including the sweeping impacts of AI proliferation across industries, with opportunities, risks, and actionable ideas highlighted by our analysts.

**AI is Everything Everywhere All at Once** — We expect the dominant focus of the conference to be the all-consuming effects of AI proliferation across sectors, with impacts across infrastructure, software business models, media, consumption patterns, and more. We expect to hear how companies are positioning relative to dynamic trends, looking for insights on product strategy, competitive edges, internal use of AI, and financial implications on growth & margins. **Top ideas include:** MDB, NOW, ZS, CRWD, MNDY, WIX, BKNG, TTWO, TKO, T, MCHP, TXN, AVGO, KLAC, IFX, ENTG, APH, DELL.

**To the Hyperscalers and Beyond** — Despite investor concerns around the sustainability and ROIC of the AI investments by hyperscalers, we see AI fundamentals as remaining intact as data center investments extend beyond into tier 2 providers and sovereign AI, with implications across semis/semicap infrastructure, data center/fiber providers, and hyperscalers themselves.

**Software Strikes Back** — A central theme for our software coverage will be whether AI will be a driver of growth for existing players or a disruptor of traditional business models. We believe investors will be focused on how management teams articulate their AI strategies, whether defensive or offensive, and the degree to which pricing models adapt to the realities of automation.

**Edge Compute of Tomorrow** — A key debate in Edge Computing is whether PC growth is benefitting from AI implementation. For now, we believe macro/tariff pressures are impacting growth and AI-PC penetration, yet affordable price points and compelling enterprise AI apps should drive wider acceptance. We see current PC growth as tempered and with likely AI more meaningful next year and beyond. We believe mini-AI servers should emerge as key applications and expect smartphones —the most responsive form factor — to lead architecture adoption.

**Ads to the Future** — We expect a key focus will be on the impact of AI on online advertisers, search-driven marketing and the evolving efficacy of those models. We'll be listening for insights on the future of Search monetization (e.g. Agentic Engine Optimization, adoption of affiliate fees) and how publishers or SaaS models are managing lower traffic and monetization levels.

**And So Much More** — In addition to the above, we expect to gain insights on the semi recovery cycle, eCommerce in a world of tariffs/AI, cybersecurity, competition & convergence in telecom, open vs. closed media, the M&A environment, and more.

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# 2025 Citi TMT Conference Preview

At Citi's 2025 Global TMT Conference, our annual flagship event for the sector, we will host over 260 corporates across the TMT landscape and over 1,500 investors over a 3-day period, including 2 keynote addresses, 4 group panels, 150 fireside chats, and over 20,000 investor meetings.

The TMT sector faces a complex set of cross-currents as the proliferation of AI catalyzes a rapidly changing set of industry dynamics, set against a murky economic backdrop, and dramatic changes to regulatory frameworks. Within this report, we have curated a list of themes we expect to resonate across sessions, including opportunities, risks, and actionable ideas highlighted by our analysts.

## ■ Gen AI Infrastructure

- Analysts: Chris Danely, Atif Malik, Laura Chen, Andrew Gardiner, Tyler Radke, Ron Josey, Michael Rollins

## ■ AI in Software – Friend or Foe?

- Analysts: Tyler Radke, Steven Enders, George Kurosawa, Ron Josey, Ygal Arounian

## ■ Edge Computing

- Analysts: Asiya Merchant, Andrew Gardiner, Peter Lee, Josh Yang, Michael Rollins

## ■ Semi Recovery Cycle

- Analysts: Chris Danely, Atif Malik, Andrew Gardiner

## ■ Online Advertising: AI Benefitting Engagement and Targeting Capabilities

- Analysts: Ron Josey, Ygal Arounian, Jason Bazinet

## ■ AI Impact on Search-Driven Marketing

- Analysts: Ron Josey, Ygal Arounian, Tyler Radke, Steven Enders

## ■ eCommerce: Impacts of Tariffs & New Agentic Shopping Tools

- Analysts: Ron Josey, Ygal Arounian, Tyler Radke

## ■ Cybersecurity & IT Ops: Friendlier AI Narrative But Nuance will Matter

- Analysts: Fatima Boolani

## ■ Assessing Competition & Convergence within Communication Services

- Analysts: Michael Rollins

## ■ Media: Open vs. Closed Ecosystems

- Analysts: Jason Bazinet

## ■ Impacts from the Regulatory Environment

- Analysts: Chris Danely, Atif Malik, Michael Rollins, Jason Bazinet, Steven Enders

■ Potential M&A Impact Across TMT

– Analysts: Chris Danely, Atif Malik, Asiya Merchant, Michael Rollins, Jason Bazinet, Steven Enders

Figure 1. Day 1 Agenda - Wednesday, September 3rd

Subject to change, please consult the official agenda on the day of the event

| Day 1 - Wednesday, September 3 |                                               |                        |                                                             |                                       |                                  |                          |                                 |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ROOMS:                         | Track 1                                       | Track 2                | Track 3                                                     | Track 4                               | Track 5                          | Track 6                  | Track 7                         |
| 8:10 AM - 8:45 AM ET           | Entegris (ENTG)                               |                        | Comp Landscape in AI, Broadband, Wireless (Recon Analytics) | Ambarella (AMBA)                      | CDW Corp (CDW)                   | Zeta Global (ZETA)       | Datarobot (Private)             |
| 8:50 AM - 9:25 AM ET           | Lam Research Corp (LRCX)                      | Intuit Inc (INTU)      | Nexstar Media (NXST)                                        | EPAM Systems (EPAM)                   | HP Inc. (HPQ)                    | GoDaddy (GDDY)           |                                 |
| 9:30 AM - 10:05 AM ET          | Marvell Technology Inc (MRVL)                 | Varonis Systems (VRNS) | Roku Inc (ROKU)                                             | CI&T Inc. (CINT)                      | Western Digital (WDC)            | Booking Holdings (BKNG)  | Uniphore Technologies (Private) |
| 10:10 AM - 10:45 AM ET         | FormFactor (FORM)                             | Okta (OKTA)            | American Tower (AMT)                                        | Peloton Interactive Inc (IFXGn.DE)    | Infineon Technologies (IFXGn.DE) | Blackline Inc. (BL)      | Applied Intuition (Private)     |
| 10:50 AM - 11:25 AM ET         | Advanced Micro Devices (AMD)                  | MNTN Inc. (MNTN)       | DigitalBridge (DBRG)                                        | Kyndryl (KD)                          | Seagate Technology (STX)         | Match Group (MTCH)       | Vast Data (Private)             |
| 11:30 AM - 12:00 PM ET         | Lunch Keynote                                 |                        |                                                             |                                       |                                  |                          |                                 |
| 12:00 PM - 12:45 PM ET         | State of the Market (Citi Investment Banking) |                        |                                                             |                                       |                                  |                          |                                 |
| 12:50 PM - 1:25 PM ET          | Keysight Technologies (KEYS)                  | ServiceNow (NOW)       | SBA Communications (SBAC)                                   | Grid Dynamics (GDYN)                  | NetApp, Inc. (NTAP)              | Applan Corp. (APPN)      | Hold for Lambda AI (Private)    |
| 1:30 PM - 2:05 PM ET           | Manhattan Associates (MANH)                   | Datadog (DDOG)         | Uniti Group Inc (UNIT)                                      | Cognizant Technology Solutions (CTSH) | Amphenol Corp (APH)              | ACV Auctions Inc. (ACVA) | ID.me, Inc (Private)            |
| 2:10 PM - 2:45 PM ET           | onsemi (ON)                                   | Shopify (SHOP)         | Lumen Technologies (LUMN)                                   | Globant SA (GLOB)                     | Teads Holding Co (TEAD)          | Dayforce (DAY)           | Pinecone Systems (Private)      |
| 2:50 PM - 3:25 PM ET           |                                               | AvePoint Inc. (AVPT)   | Amdocs (DOX)                                                | Coinbase Global Inc. (COIN)           | Paycom Software Inc (PAYC)       | Wix.com Ltd. (WIX)       | Syntiant Corp. (Private)        |
| 3:30 PM - 4:05 PM ET           | Cisco Systems (CSCO)                          | MongoDB (MDB)          | Cogent Communications (CCOI)                                | Xometry (XMTR)                        | Taboola (TBLA)                   | Wayfair (W)              | BigID (Private)                 |
| 4:10 PM - 4:45 PM ET           | Rezolve AI (RZLV)                             | SimilarWeb (SMWB)      | Bezeq (BEZQ.TA)                                             | ExlService (EXLS)                     | Ziff Davis (ZD)                  | LegalZoom.com (LZ)       | Dataiku (Private)               |

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Source: Citi Research

Figure 2. Day 2 Agenda - Thursday, September 4th

Subject to change, please consult the official agenda on the day of the event

| Thursday, September 4  |                                   |                                  |                                            |                                      |                                  |                              |                                            |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| ROOMS:                 | Track 1                           | Track 2                          | Track 3                                    | Track 4                              | Track 5                          | Track 6                      | Track 7                                    |
| 7:30 AM - 8:05 AM ET   | Microchip Technology (MCHP)       | CCC Intelligent Solutions (CCCS) | TDS Telecom & Array Digital Infrastructure | Zscaler (ZS)                         | Blackbaud, Inc. (BLKB)           |                              | Physical AI: Locus Robotics (Private)      |
| 8:10 AM - 8:45 AM ET   | Texas Instruments (TXN)           | Autodesk (ADSK)                  | Comcast Communications (CMCSA)             | ADT Inc. (ADT)                       | SPS Commerce (SPSC)              | Teradyne (TER)               | Enterprise Applications in AI Panel        |
| 8:50 AM - 9:25 AM ET   | Astera Labs Inc (ALAB)            | Microsoft Corp (MSFT)            | Verizon Communications (VZ)                | CoStar Group Inc. (CSGP)             | Corning (GLW)                    | OneStream (OS)               | AI Platforms: Perplexity (Private)         |
| 9:30 AM - 10:05 AM ET  | KLA Corp (KLAC)                   | Teradata Corp (TDC)              | IHS Holding Ltd (IHS)                      | Alight (ALIT)                        | Super Micro Computer (SMC)       | Box Inc (BOX)                | Quantum Panel                              |
| 10:10 AM - 10:45 AM ET | Arista Networks (ANET)            | CheckPoint Software (CHKP)       | Clear Channel Outdoor Holdings (CCO)       | Automatic Data Processing (ADP)      | Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) | Fiverr International (FVRR)  | Island (Private)                           |
| 10:50 AM - 11:25 AM ET | Analog Devices (ADI)              | Dynatrace Inc. (DT)              | New York Times Company / The (NYT)         | First Advantage Corporation (FA)     | AGCO Corp. (AGCO)                | Ibotta Inc. (IBTA)           | Data in AI: Poolside (Private)             |
| 11:30 AM - 12:00 PM ET | Lunch Keynote                     |                                  |                                            |                                      |                                  |                              |                                            |
| 12:00 PM - 12:45 PM ET | Palo Alto Networks (PANW)         |                                  |                                            |                                      |                                  |                              |                                            |
| 12:50 PM - 1:25 PM ET  | Intel Corp (INTC)                 | PTC Inc (PTC)                    | Sirius XM Holdings (SIRI)                  | Genpact (G)                          | Criut (CRCT)                     | Criteo (CRTC)                | Creativity in AI: Runway (Private)         |
| 1:30 PM - 2:05 PM ET   | Universal Display (OLED)          | NICE Ltd. (NICE)                 | Unity Software (U)                         | Clearwater Analytics Holdings (CWAN) | Celastica (CLS)                  | Grab Holdings (GRAB)         | Agentic AI Panel                           |
| 2:10 PM - 2:45 PM ET   | Onto Innovation (ONTO)            | Veeva Systems Inc. (VEEV)        | Outfront Media Inc (OUT)                   | Akamai Technologies (AKAM)           | Docobo (DCBO)                    | Grindr (GRND)                | Future of Photonics: Lightmatter (Private) |
| 2:50 PM - 3:25 PM ET   | Advanced Energy Industries (AEIS) | Elastic NV (ESTC)                | AT&T Inc. (T)                              | Capgemini (CAPP.PA)                  | SoundHoundAI (SOUN)              | OpenText Corp (OTEX)         | Proofpoint (Private)                       |
| 3:30 PM - 4:05 PM ET   | Nova (NVMI)                       | Sprinklr (CXM)                   | T-Mobile US (TMUS)                         | Wasabi Technologies (Private)        | WiseTech Global (WTC.AX)         | Asana (ASAN)                 | AI in Defense: Primer AI (Private)         |
| 4:10 PM - 4:45 PM ET   | Lasertec Corp (6920.T)            | Amplitude (AMPL)                 | Super Group (SGHC)                         | Inflection (Private)                 | Logitech International (LOGI)    | Pegasystems (PEGA)           | Agentic AI: Cognition (Private)            |
| 4:50 PM - 5:25 PM ET   | Silicon Laboratories (SLAB)       |                                  | SoftBank Group Corp. (9984.T)              |                                      | Magnite (MGNI)                   | Nextdoor Holdings Inc (KIND) | AI Infrastructure: Crusoe (Private)        |

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Source: Citi Research

Figure 3. Day 3 Agenda – Friday, September 5th

Subject to change, please consult the official agenda on the day of the event

| Friday, September 5   |         |                                                   |                      |                       |         |                     |         |
|-----------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|---------|---------------------|---------|
| ROOMS:                | Track 1 | Track 2                                           | Track 3              | Track 4               | Track 5 | Track 6             | Track 7 |
| 8:10 AM - 8:45 AM ET  |         |                                                   | Gannett Co Inc (GCI) | Endava Plc (DAVA)     |         | Life360, Inc. (LJF) |         |
| 8:50 AM - 9:25 AM ET  |         | Braze (BRZE)                                      | Genius Sports (GENI) |                       |         | Opera Ltd. (OPRA)   |         |
| 9:30 AM - 10:05 AM ET |         | VC Panel – Perspectives on Enterprise AI Adoption |                      | Riot Platforms (RIOT) |         | DoubleVerify (DV)   |         |

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## Themes to Watch at Citi’s 2025 Global TMT Conference

### GenAI Infrastructure

Despite strong hyperscale capex in the June quarter and solid expectations that capex will continue to grow in 2026, investor concerns are resurfacing around the sustainability and ROIC of the AI investments by the hyperscalers, particularly after Open AI CEO, Sam Altman, commenting that an AI bubble may be forming. While concerns on hyperscaler capex cuts will likely ebb and flow, AI fundamentals remain intact. We believe investors should focus on these emerging themes for data center buildouts which we believe will be increasingly important in 2026:

- **AI demand expands beyond hyperscalers to sovereign AI and Tier 2 clouds (Chris Danely/ Atif Malik).** During our Conference, we expect AMD, MRVL, ALAB, Dell and HPE to provide more details on the sovereign AI and Tier 2 cloud opportunities. AMD recently noted that it has over 40 active sovereign AI engagements and expects meaningful contribution in 2026. MRVL recently announced a new ASIC customer, which we believe is a Tier 2 or a neocloud customer and ALAB also discussed seeing its Scorpio X engagements ramp to 10 customers. Dell, SMCI and HPE have similarly been seeing robust demand from Tier 2/ Tier 3 cloud customers, along with material opportunities with sovereign customers.
- **800G Ethernet driving stronger AI backend network adoption, expanding scale-out Ethernet TAM (Chris Danely/ Atif Malik).** Continued data center build out is expanding the scale-out Ethernet TAM, and we see 800G Ethernet driving stronger adoption in AI backend networks by hyperscalers as performance approaches that of InfiniBand. During our Conference, we expect positive commentary from CLS and ANET on their 800G Ethernet market opportunity and customer ramps. While we favor merchant solutions over white box makers like neutral-rated CLS in 2H25, we believe buy-rated ANET and AVGO will also be the main beneficiaries of the 400G to 800G Ethernet migration. We continue to expect interconnect companies like APH and GLW to continue benefiting from rising demand for high-speed low latency interconnect demand inter and intra data centers
- **Storage (Asiya Merchant):** While External Enterprise Storage market spending has yet to significantly inflect (relative to compute spending over recent years), AI-related drivers continue to support general EB growth including the growth of Enterprise datalakes as a result of increased data retention rates (to improve monetization and to better justify AI-related ROI), as well as the emerging creation/use of synthetic data, increased traction and expansion of AI applications (“killer apps”), and the forthcoming effect of AI-driven data

generation into data-intensive images and video. We remain constructive on the use of NAND Flash/eSSDs in modern, high-IOPS advanced workloads, including AI, on the usage of tiered storage of high-capacity enterprise drives (GPU caching) while the majority of cold data contained in modern datacenters continues to be stored on HDDs, given 6x cost differential.

■ **AI ASIC chip sales to outpace GPU sales in 2026 – AVGO is our top pick (Chris Danely/ Atif Malik/ Laura Chen):** While NVDA GPUs will continue to dominate the AI compute market, we believe the ASIC market will likely start to accelerate in 2H25 and into 2026. We expect the AI ASIC market to grow 53% YoY in 2026, outpacing AI GPU sales growth of 34% YoY (please see [note](#)), predominantly driven by ramps by Google, Meta and Amazon. We expect MRVL and ALAB to highlight the growing ASIC TAM and express confidence in their market share opportunity. AVGO is our top AI ASIC pick, and we expect upside to Consensus estimates when they present on September 4, driven by custom AI ASIC ramps by Google and Meta. We are also Buy-rated on other ASIC beneficiaries such as Marvell and Mediatek.

■ **Advanced packaging and High-NA EUV crucial in manufacturing next-gen AI chips (Laura Chen/ Andrew Gardiner):** As AI semiconductor manufacturing transitions from the N5/4 nodes to N3 nodes, TSMC continues to extend its manufacturing moat with its vertical integrated advanced packaging roadmap including CoWoS, SoIC and COUPE. ASML's EUV lithography is also critical in node transition as it enables sub-10nm patterning in a single exposure step, which reduces manufacturing complexity and enhances yield. We are Buy-rated on TSMC and ASML.

– **Relevant Tickers:** AMD, MRVL, ALAB, DELL, HPE, CLS, ANET, AVGO, NVDA, 2454-TW (MediaTek), TSMC, ASML, SMCI, APH, GLW, WDC, STX, SNDK

■ **Application Software (Tyler Radke):** MSFT will be the key name to watch at the conference with the most investor interest by far. We've recently seen a clear uptick in AI demand reflected in Azure standout 4-pt beat in 2 consecutive quarters with growth now close to the 40% mark. Management has been pointing to capacity constraints persisting longer than expected and an accelerated CapEx ramp in 1H, where we are expecting spend of ~\$110B in FY26. MSFT also is uniquely positioned to benefit from AI at multiple layers; not only through the Azure infrastructure backbone for model training and deployment, but also through embedding AI across its own SaaS products (M365, Dynamics, Github, etc). The Maia custom AI accelerator chip is over a year old now and can help them increase efficiency by better optimizing cost and performance for both internal use and customer deployments. They can also embed their solutions with their own LLMs and have first access to OpenAI's models given their significant investment stake and partnership. Heading into the event, we will be listening for any intra-quarter demand or macro commentary that could shed light on the sustainability of Azure acceleration and the degree to which efficiency gains translate into bottom-line leverage.

– **Relevant tickers:** MSFT

■ **US Internet (Ron Josey):** Given the opportunity and demand for AI services and tools, at the conference we will be focused on commentary around continued CapEx infrastructure spend and insights on Google's Ironwood TPUs, Amazon's Trainium / Inferentia chips, and Meta's MTIA chips. Collectively across Amazon, Google/Alphabet, and Meta, we project total 2026E CapEx infrastructure spend to reach ~\$296B (+24% Y/Y) and for this to reach ~\$445B by 2029E. That said,

while Amazon's AWS and Google's Cloud invests in infrastructure to catchup to cloud demand trends, we view Meta's investments as mostly focused on building out its platform with near-term and long-term benefits. We highlight investments in AI ranking and recommendations and AI advertising tools as driving greater time spent and improved conversions while investments in Llama LLMs, Glasses, and Super Intelligence are geared to medium / longer-term initiatives.

– **Relevant Tickers:** AMZN, GOOGL, META

■ **Telecom (Michael Rollins):** The key GenAI Infrastructure themes within our coverage that we anticipate will be highlighted at the conference include:

– **Favorable Data Center Demand:** GenAI Infrastructure debates largely focus on the data center demand environment in 2H25 and on a multi-year basis, especially for hyperscale deployments. Not surprisingly, 2Q hyperscale leasing was lighter within the category. We still expect stronger data center demand during the 2H25 and continued momentum in 2026. Early indications have been positive. DLR is seeing greater interest from hyperscalers early in 3Q. Vantage recently announced a \$25 billion campus development for hyper-scale deployments in Texas with 1.4 GW of total IT Load capacity, which likely includes pre-leasing. We remain a Buyer of EQIX shares, which will not be at the conference, as we expect favorable core demand to continue into the 2H25. We remain positive on Buy-rated DLR, which should remain a beneficiary from favorable demand for both retail-centric bookings (<1 MW) and hyper-scale leasing. We believe the industry remains on track for global IT absorption (ex-China) in 2025 of at least 9.5 GWs and an average of at least 10 GW between 2026 and 2030, as we forecasted in our note: [Power On: Forecasting Favorable Multi-Year IT Load Demand from AI Adoption, Even if 2025 Takes a Step Back and Is 2H Weighted](#).

– **Expanding Dark Fiber Demand:** GenAI workloads are also contributing to an acceleration in demand for upfront dark fiber sales. Lumen has already booked roughly \$9 billion of contract value to expand connectivity, including from hyperscalers deploying AI workloads. We expect Lumen to stay positive on the opportunity to capture some additional fiber IRU sales (aka PCF) as well as the modernization of its go-to-market to improve its share of connectivity with on-demand bandwidth services. Uniti has highlighted a sales pipeline of \$1.5B of contract value and is also a potential beneficiary from the expanding demand for dark fiber. While the other Telcos, such as AT&T and Verizon, may share some positive data points on incremental demand from AI workloads, the ongoing erosion of legacy services is apt to hold back aggregate business wireline segment performance in the near-term.

– **Relevant Tickers:** DLR, EQIX, LUMN, T, VZ.

## AI in Software – Friend or Foe?

A central theme for our software coverage as well as the conference at large will be whether AI will be a driver of growth for existing players or a disruptor of traditional business models. With a broad mix of enterprise, data analytics, infrastructure, security, vertical, marketing/e-commerce focused, and back-office software vendors in attendance alongside a panel of venture investors, the discussion is expected to focus on both the risks and opportunities created by rapid AI adoption.



We believe investors will be focused on how management teams articulate their AI strategies, whether defensive or offensive, and the degree to which pricing models adapt to the realities of automation.

■ **Application Software (Tyler Radke):** The core themes impacting our coverage where we expect clarity from the conference include:

- **Business Model Resilience:** Seat-based models face the greatest structural risk as AI-enabled automation reduces headcount requirements for certain workflows. While the broad software selloff may have over-discounted this risk, differentiation between models is key. We view usage-based, and consumption-aligned models (SNOW, MDB, ESTC) as best positioned to accelerate growth given an impending enterprise pivot towards productionalizing AI applications and rise in inferencing workloads. Additionally, NOW has the most resilient seat-based model given their AI orchestration lens and deep customer relationships as we look for clarity on their usage-based revenue outlook.
- **Hyperscaler Tailwinds & AI Innovation:** MSFT and other hyperscalers have emerged as first-mover beneficiaries from AI workloads, given their infrastructure control and ability to monetize consumption and SaaS offering by partnering or launching their own LLMs. GenAI has further democratized access to data insights across enterprises, with data platform vendors like SNOW, MDB, ESTC and TDC playing key roles in AI innovations that help enterprises increase operational efficiency and reduce costs. These platforms are pivotal in enhancing data value by providing the foundational infrastructure for data access, management, and by facilitating seamless integration with Large Language Models (LLMs) to drive richer, more actionable insights. This enables enterprises to achieve their ROI expectations, paving the way for an eventual inflection towards agentic AI adoption.
- **Vertical Strength:** High-quality vertical applications such as ADSK, VEEV, CCC, and PTC are also well positioned to leverage AI within their specialized domains where integration with core industry workflows creates lasting and defensible moats. Differentiation strategies we believe can be highest for these names, though given the complexity it is taking longer for them to release monetizable AI solutions.
- **Marketing & Commerce:** Companies like BRZE, SHOP and KYVO can benefit from AI-driven personalization and campaign optimization and serve as downstream beneficiaries of hyperscaler and model innovation. The increased personalization, while tougher to directly monetize, should yield higher ROI on marketing & commerce software spend through better conversion/sales metrics for merchants and brands. This will ultimately help drive upsells and higher retention rates over time.
- **Increased Desire for M&A:** The VC panel is likely to highlight an increase in M&A activity as incumbents seek to accelerate their AI roadmaps through targeted acquisitions. Successful AI start-ups that demonstrate product-market fit and integration readiness could be attractive targets.
- **Companies we view most at risk:** NICE and CXM we see as most at risk given their heavy reliance on seat-based pricing models within customer engagement markets which have been some of the first use cases to be

impacted by AI. AI agents replacing human seats remains a key question that leaves uncertainty around terminal value estimates.

- **Relevant tickers:** ADSK, AMPL, BRZE, CCCS, CXM, ESTC, KYVO, MDB, MSFT, NICE, NOW, PTC, SHOP, SMWB, TDC, VEEV

- **Back Office Software (Steve Enders/ George Kurosawa):** AI sentiment within Back Office Software has turned overly negative in our view, with concerns around seat-based pricing and competitive displacement fears contributing to broad-based underperformance for most of our coverage. Yet, we see green shoots of AI monetization across our coverage including separate SKUs, pricing/up-tiering, and strengthened expansion motions, while those exposed to seat-based pricing models have worked to diversify to usage-based models. At the conference, we expect clarity on AI growth contribution and AI risk mitigation, seeing more AI upside for cos with data advantages, clear ROI-driven value props, and less seat-based risk like APPN, BOX, INTU, and PEGA.

- **Relevant Tickers:** APPN, ASAN, BL, BOX, DAY, DBX, INTU, MNDY, OS, OTEX, PAYC, PEGA, WK, SPSC, MANH, ROP

- **US Internet (Ron Josey):** A key focus for both **Amazon** and **Alphabet** revolves around adoption of the AI tools, services, and agentic tools offered by each platform. For **AWS**, we'll be listening for insights on Bedrock usage (including adoption of its own proprietary Nova FMs), Kiro (its coding software), AgentCore, and AWS Transform (for mainframe modernization), among other AWS tools. For **Google Cloud**, we're focused on Gemini adoption and given 85K+ enterprises now building with Gemini resulting in a ~35x growth in usage Y/Y as of 2Q, there is clearly demand. While on a smaller scale, we'll be listening for insights on how **LegalZoom** is increasingly incorporating AI into its legal and compliance software solutions as well as its new partnerships with Perplexity and OpenAI and adoption of **Fiverr Go** and benefits on conversions and improved matching.

- **US SMID Cap Internet (Ygal Arounian):** We see **WIX** and **GDDY** as **GenAI winners not losers**. The debate around GenAI disrupted business models is particularly debated within our SMB software/web builder coverage (WIX and GDDY) as new "vibe coding" platforms are seeing rapid growth in ARR as they allow users to build applications and websites using natural human language to code. Both Wix and GoDaddy have seemingly been determined to be AI losers by the market and potentially bound to be displaced (WIX -43% and GDDY -32% since 2/13/2025). However, we see GenAI web building as additive to WIX and GDDY's TAM, potentially driving better growth of web building and driving ARPU upside. So far, vibe coding is not replacing SaaS website building and visual editing. It is being used more for application development, particularly around prototyping. And there is a complex backbone of website and business tools needed to fully run a business-oriented website. Wix and GoDaddy are both seeing their top of funnel trends get stronger as vibe coding startups grow. Wix in particular has done a strong job launching GenAI tools, including acquiring its own fast growing vibe coding platform, Base44 (growing to \$40-\$50mm of ARR exiting 2025, from mid-single digits when acquired on 6/18). Wix management notes that it sees no overlap between Base44 and its core product.

- **Relevant Tickers:** AMZN, GOOGL, WIX (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), GDDY (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), LZ (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), FVRR (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings)



## Edge Computing

A key debate on AI in Edge Computing is whether PC growth is seeing any benefit from the implementation of AI. For now, we believe that macro and tariff pressures are impacting near-term PC growth rates, and as a result the penetration of AI-PCs. However, we also believe more affordable price points and the emergence of more compelling enterprise AI applications (or “killer apps”, beyond the current common demonstrated use cases of summarizing emails, screenshots, phone calls and meetings) should drive wider acceptance. We see current PC growth as more tempered and believe AI impacts should become more meaningful next year and beyond.

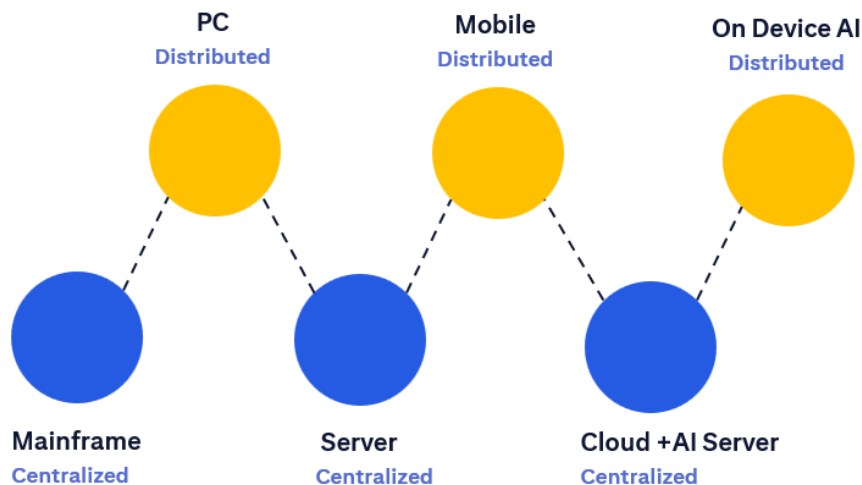
- **AI PC Impacts Protracted on Macro/Tariffs (Asiya Merchant):** While underlying demand drivers, including Win 10 EOL, remain intact, our expectation for [PC demand in 2025 is more tempered](#) given the potential impact from tariff-induced price inflation and continued macro uncertainty leading to limited 2H demand visibility. Within this total PC backdrop, AI PC shipments (defined by IDC as containing either NPUs or discrete GPUs of 100TOPs+ (trillions of operations per second)) reached 76.7M in 2024, or ~30% share, and are projected to grow at a 28.4% CAGR (2024- 2029E) to 267M units, or ~98% share. We model CY25E Citi PC OEM unit growth +3%/y and believe PC demand recovery will remain bumpy given macro uncertainty, with AI impacts likely further in the coming years.

The industry is expecting improved demand in 2026 as price points improve and more compelling use cases emerge, including efforts by Nvidia, Intel, AMD, Qualcomm, and Microsoft working with independent software vendors (ISVs) to build new AI features that can better leverage local silicon, which should accelerate traction through the coming years, including agentic-AI which IDC expects to serve as a significant inflection point.

**Smartphones to Benefit from Reduced AI Model Sizes:** Over the medium- to longer-term, we expect a significant reduction in AI model sizes, accelerating architectural changes in portable devices where AI models can be embedded directly into edge devices, and we believe mini-AI servers should emerge as key applications and expect smartphones – which are the most responsive form factor to rapidly changing use cases – to lead architecture adoption. IDC forecasts Gen-AI smartphones to grow at +78.4% CAGR from 2023 to 2028E, vs 2.3% for total smartphone market, or more than 70% of the smartphones are expected to have gen-AI capabilities by 2028E. See our latest Smartphone report: [Global Tech Hardware - 2Q25 Smartphone Shipment Slightly Ahead; 2H25 Likely Stable](#)

We expect these future personal AI servers to become portable in various form factors including smartphones, laptops, as well as smart glasses. As a result, we see AI smartphone/AI PC/robotics markets as promising given continued progress of Gen-AI use cases. See our comprehensive report: [Global Semiconductors - The AI Hardware Shift in IT Devices: The Era of Personal AI Server Begins](#).

Figure 4. Technology Advancement from AI



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Source: Citi Research

Architecturally, a hybrid AI model will have some edge devices contain only sufficient computing power to perform local training, while edge devices may then offload certain computational activity to the cloud for more complex or resource-intensive processing tasks. Some of the most common demonstrated use cases include summarizing emails, screenshots, phone calls and meetings.

- **Energy Efficient Architectures (Andrew Gardiner/ Laura Chen):** This should also leverage more of energy-efficient processor architectures and may benefit ARM, as their chip architectures are well-suited for building specialized AI accelerators and for executing highly efficient GenAI inference workloads. Such designs are highly sought after for custom CPUs, particularly where power consumption is a critical factor, enabling the deployment of complex AI models across a wider range of platforms, from compact edge devices to increasingly efficient data center solutions for AI.

Portable edge AI servers must be cost- and energy-efficient to fully operate AI models in edge devices. In order to realize such characteristics, we anticipate a broader adoption of heterogeneous integration from a hardware perspective, with TSMC's SoIC playing a central role in enabling this. We further expect mobile DRAM to be increasingly adopted for edge devices. Specifically, we foresee LPDDR6 adoption for flagship devices to start in 2026E and LPW DRAM to become mainstream by 2028E. Lastly, die-to-die integration via hybrid bonding will get more widely adopted.

- **Major Architectural Shifts (Peter Lee/ Josh Yang):** We also foresee three major architectural shifts in on-device AI products. The first architecture direction we foresee is that AI kits will be added to conventional Von Neumann architectures, integrating AI modules in PCIe. The second architecture direction is the use of near memory or LPDDR6 with increased I/Os & bandwidth near NPU & TPU. The last architecture direction we anticipate is implementation of LPW/LLW DRAM near NPU/TPU, which can be seen as mini Nvidia's AI server architecture.

In particular, we expect that the SRAM contribution in logic chips for future Edge

AI computing will either decline or become limited, while the use of LPDDR6 and Low Latency Wide I/O (LPW) is likely to expand.

- **Telecom (Michael Rollins):** The increasing adoption of Gen-AI workloads and the rising mix of inference should eventually be constructive for retail data center demand. The opportunity for enterprises to deploy their own private inference and adopt hybrid-AI models (similar to the cloud) may still take some time. We continue to like the durability of the retail-centric data center models that differentiate their offerings with robust connectivity and proximity to major population centers (and GDP). We view Buy-rated EQIX and DLR as potential beneficiaries, while Buy-rated AMT's CoreSite business should also be a beneficiary.
- **Edge Computing Overall Beneficiaries:** We believe that device architectures adopted across portable IT devices should ultimately evolve into AI server-like architectures where DRAM is placed adjacent to NPU/TPU to maximize AI operation. We identify potential beneficiaries of this shift as: Apple, HP Inc., Hynix, Samsung, TSMC, Micron, Nvidia, ASML, ARM, Qualcomm, Mediatek, Dell, Besi, ASMPT, Advantest, Disco, KLA, Lam Research, AMAT, Techwing, Mitsubishi Electric, Panasonic, Ibiden, Asus, MSI, Lenovo, Tokyo Ohka, SUMCO. Additionally, we see constructive trend in retail data center demand, seeing benefits to EQIX, DLR, and AMT.

## Semi Recovery Cycle

- **Within analog semiconductors (Chris Danelly/ Andrew Gardiner),** the biggest debate going into Citi Tech Conference is the durability of the cyclical recovery and the extent which tariff-related pull-ins drove the strong 2Q25 results and 3Q25 guidance. While we believe there is some tariff-related pull-ins in the Auto and Industrial end markets (combined 23% of semi sales), we believe the analog upturn remains intact driven by low inventory, depressed margins, and improving demand.
  - **Conference focus:** Analog semi companies such as TXN, ADI, ON, MCHP, Infineon, and STM will be presenting at our Conference and we expect them to provide incrementally positive datapoints on 2H25 outlook, led by strength from the Industrial end market, along with stabilization in the Auto end market. We also expect the companies to discuss their manufacturing strategies in relation to the tariff policies.
  - **Top US analog pick: MCHP and we expect positive pre-announcement** – Buy-rated MCHP is our top analog pick as we believe they will exhibit the most upside to estimates given its sales and margins have fallen the most from the peak. MCHP raised guidance at a Conference back in June, and we expect them to do the same at our Conference as bookings and visibility appear to be improving.
  - **Top European analog pick: Infineon** – Buy-rated Infineon is our top analog pick in Europe, and we expect them to continue to sound more optimistic in comparison to peers, as they are further along the cycle on better management, benefiting from growth in its AI revenue, China xEV exposure, and MCU share gains.
  - **Less positive on ON semiconductor:** In contrast, we expect Neutral-rated ON to underperform the group as we expect gross margins to remain under pressure due to slowing growth in the lower-gross margin Silicon Carbide business (13% of sales).

- **In the semiconductor equipment space (Atif Malik)**, the biggest debate is WFE growth in 2026, China spending, and seasonality of leading-edge investment after a disappointing October-quarter guidance from AMAT.
  - **Conference focus:** We expect companies such as ENTG, LRCX, FORM, TER, KLAC, OLED, ONTO (we don't cover), AEIS, NVMI to provide more clarifications of domestic China spending, GAA ramp and timing given limited number of leading-edge customers, and market share dynamics.
  - **Our top picks in Semi Equipment** are KLAC & LRCX in large cap and NVMI in SMID cap on leading edge exposure and NAND upgrade.
  - **Positive Catalyst Watch on Entegris:** We recently opened a positive catalyst watch on ENTG going into Citi's Tech Conference on Sep 3. We will be hosting a fireside chat with the company's new CEO David Reeder and Executive Chairman & prior CEO Bertrand Loy. We expect the new CEO to talk about initial thoughts on his top priorities in the near- and long-term, as well as strategies to further streamline the business portfolio and unlock more shareholder value.
- **Relevant Attendees:** TXN (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), ADI (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), ON (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), MCHP (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), MPWR (1x1 meetings on 9/3 and 9/4), STM (1x1 meetings on 9/3), IFX (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), ENTG (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), LRCX (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), FORM (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), TER (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), KLAC (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), OLED (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), AEIS (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), NVMI (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings)

## Online Advertising: AI Benefitting Engagement and Targeting Capabilities

We believe the broader online advertising environment is relatively healthy, particularly for scaled platforms (like META & GOOGL) that are leveraging AI to drive engagement and improve targeting & campaign automation as the broader advertising market shifts to more performance and outcome-based ad formats. This comes as secular growth drivers around Connected TV (CTV) and Retail Media deliver greater advertising growth across platforms and Marketplaces (like UBER, DASH, and CART). That said, as search functionality evolves with the rise of GenAI search tools like ChatGPT and Perplexity along with Google's AI-Overviews and AI-Mode, we'll be listening for insights on the future of Search monetization (like Agentic Engine Optimization and adoption of affiliate fees and take rates) and how publishers are managing lower traffic levels given this evolution.

- **US Internet (Ron Josey):** At the conference, we'll be focused on advertising demand trends, whether there have been any changes to the industry following relatively strong 2Q results, and demand from newer online adv channels like CTV, GenAI Search, and Retail Media. Across our coverage, **META** remains our top pick given AI catalysts for engagement & monetization; **RDDT** has multiple product (Answers) and monetization (Performance) tailwinds as DAU growth stabilizes; **PINS** continues to capture greater lower funnel wallet share; and **GOOGL** Search and YT momentum continue. Both **MNTN** & **NXDR** will be presenting at our conference and we'll be listening for CTV adoption among SMBs for MNTN and progress with NXDR's NEXT platform as it reinvents the app to become a daily use case and potentially reaccelerate revenue growth.

■ **US SMID Cap Internet (Ygal Arounian):** While debate has increased among investors regarding the health of open internet advertising, both Retail Media and CTV continue to be strong secular tailwinds here as we project both to grow double-digits next year with advertisers shifting more to outcome-based ad formats. Both have been a critical growth driver of open internet spending, with **TTD** being a key leader within ad tech on both fronts. We'll hear from **CRTO's** CEO as it has been a primary Retail Media beneficiary serving the long-tail and is now investing more into CTV as it expands its full funnel offering to agencies. CRTO is also well positioned to play an important role in the future of GenAI ecommerce advertising as it has particular strength in retail data. We'll also be hosting firesides with CEOs of digital publisher **ZD** and adtech firm **TEAD** (and 1x1s with **IAC** owner of People), both of which have faced questions from investors regarding exposure to GenAI Search but each have noted resiliency of their overall ads business as we look for growth drivers into 2026.

– **Relevant Attendees:** **TTD** (1x1 meetings on 9/3); **IAC** (1x1 meetings on 9/4); **ZD** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings); **MNTN** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings); **CRTO** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings); **NXDR** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings); **TEAD** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings); **ZETA** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings); **MGNI** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings) **TBLA** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings); **RAMP** (1x1 meetings on 9/3).

■ **Media (Jason Bazinet):** We believe there are two noteworthy developments within the digital ad ecosystem that we will look to get more tactical on during our conference.

– Following a recent US court ruling, **Apple** adjusted its app store policy to allow app developers to set up external payment systems. As a result, we see scope for customer lifetime values (LTV) to expand for app developers on the back of these recent changes to and believe this LTV expansion may result in an uptick in digital advertising spend. In the short term, we believe this will benefit companies with mobile gaming exposure like **Take-Two** and **EA** (both attending our conference), which we estimate may see a potential 10% and 2% uplift to EBITDA, respectively (see note [here](#)). Longer term, we believe the benefit will spill over to the AdTech companies like **APP** and **Unity**, with the latter attending our conference. We estimate lower domestic app store fees could drive ~\$9 billion of incremental mobile gaming ad spend, which estimate implies 12% increase in EBITDA for Unity and ~6% increase for APP.

– We will be listening to commentary from **Roku** on its recent Amazon partnership. In June, Roku announced it will integrate Amazon's DSP with Roku's CTV inventory and provide Amazon's DSP exclusive functionality to identify viewers across streaming channels. The company highlighted promising early results, noting the integrated solution has allowed advertisers to reach ~40% more unique viewers with the same budget and reduce duplicative ads by ~30%. All told, Roku pointed to how preliminary results have translated to ~3x more value on ad spend and believe the move enhances Roku's competitive positioning in the CTV space. With the integration set to go live later this year, we will be listening to any commentary on expectations related to the Amazon partnership. In addition, we will be listening for any potential commentary on the scope for upside to M&E ad spend from the launch of ESPN's DTC app and FOX One.

– **Relevant Attendees:** **TTWO** (1x1 meetings on 9/3); **EA** (1x1 meetings on 9/3); **U** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings); **ROKU** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings)

## AI Impact on Search-Driven Marketing

With the emergence of AI agents and GenAI search, the Search monetization ecosystem is fundamentally changing. We note the adoption of ChatGPT given its ~700M WAUs while the use case on Google is evolving as AI Overviews, AI Mode, and its Gemini app gain greater share of searches. This evolution is impacting both monetization and traffic across business models including for marketing driven software companies. Zero-click searches are impacting publisher referral traffic with some studies showing an up to 25% Y/Y decline in referral traffic from Google Search (per Digital Content Next) and a 35% decrease in clickthrough rate (CTR) when AI Overviews appear (per Ahrefs). In our view, this shift should favor top domains/publishers and brands (e.g. Zillow in Real Estate, W in home goods ecommerce, Uber in Mobility, and Tier 1 publishers) as AI systems prioritize trusted sources when aggregating information and this is likely to be a key theme at the conference.

- **US Internet (Ron Josey):** **GOOGL** is at the forefront of the evolution of Search with new offerings including AI Overviews (2B+ MAUs), AI Mode (100M+ MAUs), and its Gemini app (450M+ MAUs), though we believe these newer surfaces have proven additive to overall query volumes with AI Overviews driving 10%+ more queries globally. At the conference, we'll be watching for alternative search tools that are emerging, like Perplexity, Reddit Answers, Pinterest's Visual Search, and ChatGPT, among others.
- **US SMID Cap Internet (Ygal Arounian):** **IAC**, **ZD**, and **TEAD** have all been viewed by investors as facing secular headwinds from the evolution of GenAI Search and impact to traffic despite highlighting their smaller exposure (~7% of legacy Outbrain revenue is related at Teads, at ZD ~35% of revenue comes from O&O traffic with just 40% related to Search). And at IAC, digital advertising revenue has diversified from Search with just 28% of core sessions from this channel and just two-thirds of digital revenue is related to traffic as AI Overviews are impacting traffic and increased to ~50% of queries in 2Q25 from 35% in 1Q25. We expect to gain deeper insights into the sustainable growth drivers of their respective advertising businesses into 2026. We are also hosting **W** CEO and CFO who noted referral traffic from GenAI Search is small but increasing quickly as we'll look to learn how this channel is evolving alongside the rise of agentic AI. **EBAY** has also noted traffic from GenAI search remains small at this point, but is growing decently, and buyers through the channel are coming in with high shopping intent.
  - **Relevant Attendees:** **ZG** (1x1 meetings), **IAC** (1x1 meetings on 9/4), **ZD** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **TEAD** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **W** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **EBAY** (1x1 meetings on 9/5).
- **Application Software (Tyler Radke):** For **HUBS**, we think their seat-based model is more insulated to AI disruption with its ability to layer AI across CRM and marketing automation to expand customer value per seat. We will be interested in management commentary on how diversified inbound channels (social media, direct digital) help offset risks from potential SEO disruption from AI-driven search.
  - **Relevant Tickers:** **HUBS**
- **Back Office Software (Steve Enders):** Within Back Office Software, we see exposure to search algo changes within self-serve SMB software motions driving lower top-of-funnel from this channel, most notably impacting **MNDY**'s



2Q25 results. Still, we believe there are mitigating forces that likely dampen the ultimate impacts, in our view. First, we believe companies are adapting digital content to better show up in AI overviews (higher traffic). Second, to the extent total traffic is impacted, higher quality traffic with propensity to spend is more likely to still click thru (higher conversion rates). And finally, we note for most companies SEO is only one component (typically a small minority) of total inbound leads and companies can shift marketing spend to more productive channels where necessary. We expect company commentary at the conference to potentially help clear confusion on go-to-market impact with MNDY showing the most potential upside, in our view.

- **Relevant Attendees:** **MNDY** (1x1 meetings on 9/4), **ASAN** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), **DBX** (1x1 meetings on 9/3 & 9/4), **INTU** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **PAYC** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings)

## eCommerce: Impacts of Tariffs & New Agentic Shopping Tools

Across U.S. eCommerce, we believe the main near-term debate revolves around the health of the U.S. consumer (which has shown to be resilient thus far) against potential pricing pressures from tariff policies. Bigger picture though, consumers continue to gravitate towards more convenient services (like faster delivery) and eCommerce companies are increasingly using AI to make the merchandising and discovery process more personalized and to develop more efficient operations. In our view eCommerce adoption of total retail remains early and particularly as GenAI search becomes a larger component, we believe more sales can move online with companies that can leverage data, product selection, and the convenience factor best positioned.

- **US Internet (Ron Josey/ Ygal Arounian):** YTD eCommerce data suggests relatively strong demand trends overall and we highlight 2Q U.S. eCommerce growth of 5% Y/Y (ex-gas & autos) per the U.S. Census Bureau, a relatively successful Prime (4) Day and Wayfair's Black Friday in July event. Bigger picture, 2Q25 U.S. eCommerce penetration now at ~20.9% of retail sales (ex-autos and gas) compares to 10% in 2015, 20% in 2021 (post pandemic), and as the convenience of eCommerce led by shipping speed and greater reliability of delivery (and selection) increases, we look for penetration to reach ~25% by 2027E and for ~100 bps increases in subsequent years.
- Across our coverage, **Amazon's** mix-shift to essentials has resulted in greater wallet share while improving overall conversion rates and recently announced grocery expansion with perishable delivery to 2,300+ cities with same day service by year-end should produce continued tailwinds. AI is improving discovery and merchandising at Amazon (we note its Rufus AI shopping assistant) and is contributing to faster shipping speeds and improvements to its fulfillment center efficiency.
- On **Wayfair**, we believe it has navigated an uncertain macro/tariffs well so far, we will look to learn more about the company's anticipated impacts in 2H25, and how tariffs could impact top line trends, margins, and category market share going forward.
- **eBay** has also reported strong results with GMV growth accelerating to 6% Y/Y in 2Q25, driven by Focus Category GMV growing >10% Y/Y. We believe the company's growth investments are paying off (Focus Categories, AI, geo-

specific) and the company's pivot towards non-new in season could help maintain resilient GMV growth through various macro scenarios.

- **Peloton** will be presenting at our conference and we look forward to hearing about its future hardware and software product plans, insights on pricing, and details around Peloton Intelligence (including creating personalized coaches that adapt to individual preferences).
- We also view **Kaspi** as a unique emerging market eCommerce opportunity as it operates a dominant super app in its home country of Kazakhstan and is progressing on its ambitions to grow internationally through its Hepsiburada acquisition in Turkey.
- **Relevant Attendees:** **PTON** (fireside chat on 9/4 and 1x1 meetings); **EBAY** (1x1 meetings on 9/5); **W** (fireside chat on 9/3 and 1x1 meetings); and **KSPI** (1x1 meetings on 9/4).

■ **Application Software (Tyler Radke):** We continue to see some risk around tariffs/de minimis impacts at the end of August but are encouraged by KVYO and SHOP's accelerating growth trends post the China de minimis exemption date (May 2) while SHOP has commented that only 4% of orders on the platform are shipped under the de minimis exemption. On the AI front, agentic commerce is still early, but we feel SHOP is well-positioned to continue gaining e-commerce share across multiple vectors (internationally, enterprise, offline). Sticking with its channel-agnostic strategy, Shopify's deeper integrations with key AI participants (OpenAI, Perplexity) through Catalog, Checkout Kit, and Universal Cart (part of Checkout Kit) will open up new avenues for merchants to sell and consumers to discover products, setting up potential GMV tailwinds. We also see KVYO as an indirect beneficiary of a looming agentic-commerce wave, on the back of its tight integration with the Shopify ecosystem and status as the preferred email provider for Plus merchants. While historically, we struggled to see an Act II for Klaviyo beyond driving higher SMS attach rates and expanding into new verticals, emerging Service SKUs of Customer Hub, Helpdesk and AI Service Agents could perhaps be the most consequential upsell levers to date. Overall, investor attention is likely to center on whether these vendors can translate AI innovation into sustained customer value, growth or incremental retention. BRZE and KYVO also stand to benefit as AI improves personalization, campaign effectiveness and conversion rates.

- **Relevant Attendees:** **BRZE** (fireside chat on 9/5, 1x1 meetings), **KVYO** (1x1 meetings on 9/3), **SHOP** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings)

## Cybersecurity & IT Ops: Friendlier AI Narrative but Nuance will Matter

**Cybersecurity (Fatima Boolani):** With an overarching backdrop of security for AI usage and AI upleveling the capabilities of malicious actors (on attack volume and quality), we continue to lean favorable on data security vendors and cyber platform players that can provide comprehensive coverage (i.e. close the gaps between security sub-disciplines). However, a tight spending environment and mixed read-throughs on cyber budget growth YTD keeps us highly selective on assets that can offer a combination of compelling multi-SKU platforms, hard dollar ROI, visible operating leverage, and credible AI monetization roadmap. Our views on IT Ops realm are comparable, where growing vendor/tool consolidation activity favoring established, scaled, platform leaders and a burgeoning AI-investment narrative are thematic lynchpins. That said, of the cybersecurity and IT Ops vendors in

attendance, we are constructive on PANW, ZS, DDOG, and DT going into the sessions (CRWD for both), balanced on OKTA, VRNS and AVPT, and cautious on FTNT, CHKP.

■ **Constructive:**

- **PANW:** we see opportunities for PANW to showcase the evolution of their security for AI playbook and related monetization, especially post the acquisition of Protect AI and announced [CYBR deal](#) (expected close in F2H26). Greater insights into synergies would be well-received against 40%+ post-synergy FCFM aspirations, but more importantly we think investors are seeking deeper conviction on rationale. Net, against fresh FY26E guide, we look for the building blocks to sustainable long-term growth, particularly as it pertains to the timeframe/pathway to \$15B NGS ARR goal (targeting by FY30E on a PANW standalone-basis) in an increasingly competitive landscape.
- **ZS:** ZS could provide incremental details on their burgeoning AI story against strong execution and a growing product portfolio ([aggressive push into SecOps via acquisitions](#)) led by a new(ish) CPO. This conference is also one of new CFO Rubin's first public ZS-badged appearances, leaving the door open on broader guidance philosophy/style, especially in pursuit of NT and LT financial goals.
- **CRWD:** Bears are increasingly vocalizing core endpoint market saturation/pricing power ceilings and cash generation hiccups against lingering repercussions from "outage bills" (~\$61M impact on CF in F1Q26) with uneven impacts of new CFS program. We expect mgmt to seize on the opportunity to reinforce/remind conviction on sustainable 20%+ topline growth and ~\$10B ARR target by FY31 as CRWD encroaches into adjacent cyber sub-categories and IT budgets. Specifically, we anticipate investors need sub-discipline level platform conviction (i.e. contribution/views on sustainable growth of identity, cloud security, Next Gen SIEM, FF) and "juicier fruits" from the GTM motion (i.e. CFS outcomes, evolution of broad strategic partnerships for distribution scale). In-depth insights on AI tech vision (endpoints in a world of agents) and monetization playbook (Charlotte AI), along with unique opex-level AI operationalization (AI innovation helped deliver F1Q26's OPM beat), would all collectively buttress the premium valuation in our view.
- **Observability vendors DDOG and DT:** Both have been hamstrung by idiosyncratic overhang (DDOG with AI-native optimization/churn fears, DT with consternation around subs revs/ODC dynamics), and as such we expect most of the investor attention around: competitive momentum (both have demonstrated strong vendor consolidation activity), financial profile (profitable growth algo), and GTM tweaks/pivots. Evidence of improving investor conviction on the "long-tail" AI opportunity - one we think currently overshadowed by myopic NT focus, early cohort dynamics - remains the sentiment antidote, in our view.

■ **Balanced**

- **OKTA:** Most topical investor interest areas and discussion points may recalibrate post-F2Q26 earnings results/updates, but we expect sustained interest in the topline momentum reinvigoration case and OKTA's identity demand positioning amid newer SKU roll-outs and against growing

AI/agent adoption. The latter should also draw particular focus on implications/mgmt thoughts following PANW's recent acquisition of identity peer CYBR.

- **VRNS:** the Security for AI opportunity especially with VRNS data-protection-first ethos is potent, but >20% topline CAGR remains elusive. Itemized details on the financial algorithm (topline trajectory vs. profitability) in an increasingly competitive environment remain key for shares, particularly as mgmt recently communicated [intentions to step up investments](#).
- **AVPT:** Against a steady build-up of execution reliability/credibility for this still relatively unknown <\$400M ARR asset, discussion will likely revolve around the path to \$1B ARR and doing so profitably, with a lens into the multiple potential growth vectors (MSFT user penetration, multi-SKU adoption, multi-cloud business, channel, AI tailwinds) and the competitive data security/management environment.

#### ■ Cautious

- **Firewall/network security vendors CHKP and FTNT:** while the firewall refresh cycle is in effect, idiosyncratic fumbles, mixed demand signals, and a lack of support for subscription growth re-acceleration keeps us cautious. Net, we see limited upside despite retrenched valuations going into these sessions, especially as players here lack a well-defined AI playbook/monetization opportunity and have yet to show sustained execution rigor of the core business (both HW and SW/subs).

- **Relevant Attendees:** **PANW** (keynote on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), **ZS** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), **CRWD** (1x1 meetings on 9/3), **DDOG** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **DT** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), **OKTA** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **VRNS** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **AVPT** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **CHKP** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), **FTNT** (1x1 meetings on 9/5)

## Assessing Competition & Convergence within Communication Services

The most significant debate is the durability of annual service revenue growth for the comm services firms to drive annual profit growth. With significant competition in mobile and rising competition in broadband, the market is skeptical on long-term pricing power to drive service revenue growth. As a result, the market sensitivity to strategic volume growth trends remains elevated and we find the consensus view is that strategic volume growth (postpaid phones, cable/fiber broadband subs) are needed for the stocks to work. Second, there is uncertainty on future industry structure with a rising focus on converged service bundles (mobile + broadband), while promotional competition has picked up in wireless and structural competition has picked up in broadband from FWA and expanding fiber footprints.

Over time, AI could drive higher demand for strategic fiber connectivity and introduce substantial operating efficiencies to support better margin performance, although some of those savings are apt to be reinvested in customer acquisition and retention. Valuations are not expensive with these uncertainties, while 2025 financial performance is generally tracking for those large-cap firms with established high-level guidance. Meanwhile, FCF should get a boost from the recent tax legislation.

■ **Telecom (Michael Rollins):**

- Heading into the conference, we expect Buy-rated **AT&T** to remain the consensus favorite as a net beneficiary within the broadband market (expanding fiber TAM, rising FWA net add momentum), strategic postpaid phone growth, and improving annual FCF.
- We remain a non-consensus Buyer of **LUMN** shares, which we believe can improve equity value by articulating an improvement in net debt financial leverage more quickly than the market anticipates, while retaining positive optionality to sell AI-related fiber capacity to the hyper-scalers. At the conference, we believe management could further emphasize its opportunity to de-lever to the low-to-mid 3x range.
- We expect sentiment to improve for **Comcast** as we anticipate better broadband losses on a seasonally adjusted basis to support break-even or better broadband revenue growth, while C&E segment performance is poised to improve with a robust sports lineup for Peacock, Parks momentum, and favorable prospects for its film slate. At the conference, we believe management will highlight its refreshed go-to-market initiatives and promotional strategies to help improve broadband performance in the back half of the year.
- We remain concerned that Neutral-rated **CCOI** is experiencing tougher performance within its heritage on-network corporate and net-centric products that may hold back overall financial performance relative to consensus.
- Investments are likely to retain a positive bias for fiber infrastructure, while we expect a more normalized rate of investment into the wireless networks that should be helpful for tower leasing activity and good for Tower stocks (**CCI**, **AMT**, & **SBAC**) heading into 2026. We expect management teams to extend the constructive commentary regarding the improving domestic leasing environment at the conference.
- **Uniti** retains optionality to improve performance of its fiber assets, and the recently completed merger should create a better opportunity for investment and value creation. We continue to believe a key opportunity for bringing the Windstream and Uniti assets together is to create optionality to monetize the parts in some form. At the conference, we hope to learn more about management's thoughts on the three distinct business segments and what the Uniti's structure could look like after the completion of its strategic review.

- **Relevant Attendees:** **T** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), **LUMN** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **CMCSA** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), **CCOI** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **CCI** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), **AMT** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **SBAC** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings), **UNIT** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings)

**Media: Open vs. Closed**

**Media (Jason Bazinet):** There are two ways consumers can enjoy content. Either in a closed system where it's curated by professionals, or an open system that taps into the Creator Economy. Across four media subsectors – digital ads, video, publishing and video games – “open” models are growing faster than “closed” models (see note [here](#)). To wit: in Digital Ads, social media is beating other forms of

digital advertising. In Video, YouTube is beating Netflix. In Video Games, Roblox is beating EA and Take-Two. And, in publishing, Substack is beating New York Times and News Corp. Consumer's growing preference for "open" content has strategic implications for most "closed" models.

The debate within management companies is if they should lean into open systems in the current environment. If NYT or NWSA would buy Substack, it would help accelerate their digital pivot. Netflix opening up the platform to content creators would help regain lost viewership. And, for AAA video game publishers, embracing Roblox's business model is unlikely. However acquiring modding firms (like Take-Two's acquisition of Five M) may be a step in the right direction. We will be looking for any incremental color from the companies on addressing this narrative.

- **Relevant Attendees:** EA (1x1 meetings on 9/3), TTWO (1x1 meetings on 9/3), NYT (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), NWSA (1x1 meetings on 9/3)

## Impacts from the Regulatory Environment

The ongoing shift in the regulatory environment and the impact this has on fundamentals could be a key point of focus at the conference with impacts across multiple industries. We look for potential updates from the event with readthroughs for semis, media, telco, and software and the impact to fundamentals or market dynamics.

- **Section 232 impact / export bans / CHIPS ACT (Chris Danelly/ Atif Malik):** The US semiconductor industry is considered critical to national security and has been subject to export controls, tariffs and support measures such as the CHIPS act in the last few years. The recently proposed 100% tariffs on semiconductors are expected to have [minimal impact](#) on the US semiconductor companies as US-based semiconductor companies with in-house fabs have operations in the US and fabless companies can commit to using TSMC, Samsung, and GFS which have operations in the US. Any changes to the current status quo could materially impact supply chain, pricing dynamics and competitive positioning of US semiconductor companies.
- **APPL (Atif Malik):** Regulatory risks remain as a key downside risk for Apple. We summarize the major litigations and progress in the chart below. Investors' top concern is Google's TAC payment to Apple as part of Google's antitrust case (see our sensitivity analysis [here](#)).



Figure 5. Major Litigation & Progress

| Potential impacts from Google antitrust cases |                    |                        |                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2020                                          | Justice Department | Google Search Monopoly | Google pays 36% search revenue to Apple to be the default search engine; It's reported that Google paid \$18Bn/\$20Bn to Apple in 2021/2022 | 8/5/2024: Google ruled monopoly in search and text advertising. Actions to be taken hasn't been decided and Google can appeal.<br><br>10/8/2024: DOJ proposed behavioral and structural remedies including "limit or prohibit default agreement regarding" to TAC payments;<br><br>11/20/2024: DOJ proposed to divest Chrome<br><br>4/21/2025: 2-week trial begins to determine appropriate remedies.<br><br>Late Summer 2025: Judge Mehta expected to issue a ruling on remedies<br><br>~ Sep 2025: Google has 30 days from final judgement to appeal<br><br>Potentially multi-year appeal process till 2027+ |

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Source: Citi Research

- **EU App Store Fee Changes:** On Apr 22 2025, Apple was fined \$570M by the European Commission on failing to comply with DMA regarding allowing for the distribution of apps on its iOS operating system by means other than through the Apple App Store. While Apple is appealing, the company made changes in the EU for developers' commissions and fees related with App Store. While it is still early to determine the impact of the changes on App Store revenue, we note that since the DMA came into effect in May 2024, which implemented a reduced fee structure, we have not seen material impact to Apple's EU App Store revenue.

■ **Telecom (Michael Rollins):** The main areas of focus within the Telecom regulatory environment include:

- **Wireless Industry Structure:** Industry structure remains a significant question on the regulatory front with mixed signals from the FCC and DoJ on whether or not the wireless category needs four facilities-based providers. The expansion of LEO satellites is creating a marginal increase in competition, even though we view those constellations as largely complementary in developed markets. We believe we could gain some additional insights on future industry structure during our discussion with Roger Entner from Recon Analytics, titled "Deciphering the Competitive Landscape Across AI, Broadband, and Wireless".
- **Broadband Regulatory Environment:** The broadband regulatory environment is also unclear as to whether or not a single facilities-based high-speed broadband provider (cable or fiber) can control significantly more than half of the US market. EchoStar is in the middle of the wireless industry structure debate, while also planning to launch a LEO constellation to offer enhanced D2D connectivity.
- **Relevant Tickers:** SATS

■ **Media (Jason Bazinet):** We believe two recent developments led to Nexstar's recent announcement to acquire TEGNA. First, a US court recently struck down the 'top four' rule limiting a firm to one of the top four networks per market. Additionally, on July 8th, the FCC opened a comment window on whether to

raise the 39% cap on TV household reach. With these two touchpoints and the current administration signaling a less heavy-handed approach to regulation, we believe it gave NXST the confidence to announce and sign a definitive agreement to acquire TEGNA. The company expects the deal to close in the second half of 2026. Given the TEGNA acquisition would put NXST at ~60% of household reach, we will be listening for any incremental commentary from the company on the regulatory environment and risk of closing the deal.

– **Relevant Attendees: NXST** (fireside chat on 9/3, 1x1 meetings)

- **Back Office Software (Steve Enders):** Recent changes in the ESG regulatory landscape, particularly with EU CSRD de-scoping and SEC Climate Disclosure, has led to deal delays and headwinds for our coverage with ESG reporting exposure. We look to the conference to better understand the extent of demand headwinds and clarity on how the timeline for demand could play out. We view this as most critical for WK with ~15% of revenue from ESG with some impact to OS with an expanded portfolio for ESG reporting.

– **Relevant Attendees: OS** (fireside chat on 9/4, 1x1 meetings), **WK** (1x1 meetings on 9/3)

## Potential M&A Impact Across TMT

We see M&A becoming a potential theme across the TMT conference either from recently announced M&A or potential combinations that could make sense strategically. Key M&A considerations include:

- **US semiconductors and Hardware (Chris Danely/ Atif Malik/ Asiya Merchant):** We do not see any major M&A going on in the US semiconductor and Hardware sectors as it requires China approval, which could be difficult. However, we do believe leading compute companies will pursue tuck-in acquisitions to strengthen their technology stacks and capture the growing AI demand, as evident in the recent transactions such as AMD's acquisition of ZT systems, Qualcomm's acquisition of Alphawave, and Amphenol's acquisition of Commscope CCS assets.
- **Telecom (Michael Rollins):** The main M&A discussions within Telecom that could be discussed at the conference are included below:
  - **Consolidation Around Convergence:** We believe the comm services category is likely to consolidate further around the theme of converged mobile+broadband bundles. Within this context, AT&T and Verizon have established converged footprint opportunities that are well ahead of T-Mobile, while cable firms have the broadest bundling coverage for their footprints through the MVNO relationships. Uniti's Kinetic business could eventually become appealing to the large-cap Telcos, although we believe financial performance has to be further along to grow revenue and EBITDA on an annual basis.
  - **Data Centers:** We expect Equinix (EQIX) and Digital Realty (DLR) to remain net buyers of assets over time as well as continue expanding their co-investment initiatives to complement their retail and wholesale focuses, respectively.
  - **Media:** Over the past year, Comcast announced plans to spin its Cable Networks and Warner Bros announced a new corporate structure. We believe

Comcast and Warner Bros could pursue a merger of their strategic streaming and studio businesses.

- **Media (Jason Bazinet):** We believe sub-scale streamers could use M&A to compete more effectively with the market leader (Netflix). We see M&A as a means to help improve their consumer value proposition by broadening out their content offering, improve their IP portfolio, and realize potential cost synergies. We believe recent developments may have set the groundwork for further media M&A. First, in November 2024 Comcast announced its plan to spin its cable networks. Subsequently, Warner Bros. announced in June 2025 its plans to split into two public companies, one comprising of Global Networks and the other Streaming & Studios. We believe this may be laying the groundwork for a potential consolidation down the line (see note [here](#)). Following the finalization of the Paramount-Skydance deal a few weeks ago, we would also not be surprised if the firm looked to further M&A to broaden out its business.
- **Back Office Software (Steve Enders):** Following the announced M&A of Dayforce by Thoma Bravo (see our note [here](#)), we could see another wave of software M&A following the recent pullback in software valuations. Beyond read throughs on market dynamics in HCM with PAYC, we could see the discussion shift to other potential takeouts in the market that could fit with a strategic or under PE ownership. We see best of breed SMID cap stocks with attractive valuations that could fit into a broader portfolio as most likely including BL, BOX, VERX, and WK.

#### Companies Mentioned:

ACV Auctions (ACVA.K; US\$12.15; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | ADT, Inc. (ADT.N; US\$8.81; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Advanced Energy Industries, Inc (AEIS.O; US\$154.52; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Advanced Micro Devices (AMD.O; US\$167.76; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Advantest (6857.T; ¥10765.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Agco Corporation (AGCO.N; US\$116.75; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Akamai Technologies, Inc. (AKAM.O; US\$77.64; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Alight Inc (ALIT.N; US\$3.87; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Alphabet Inc (GOOGL.O; US\$206.09; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Amazon.com, Inc. (AMZN.O; US\$228.84; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | American Tower Corp (AMT.N; US\$211.88; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Amphenol Corp (APH.N; US\$109.36; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Amplitude Inc (AMPL.O; US\$11.55; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Analog Devices (ADI.O; US\$252.2; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Appian Corp (APPN.O; US\$29.81; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Apple, Inc. (AAPL.O; US\$227.76; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Applied Materials Inc (AMAT.O; US\$162.49; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Applovin (APP.O; US\$441.68; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Arista Networks (ANET.N; US\$133.25; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Arm Holdings PLC (ARM.O; US\$137.92; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Asana Inc (ASAN.N; US\$14.47; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | ASML Holding NV (ASML.AS; €646.2; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:30) | Astera Labs, Inc (ALAB.O; US\$179.09; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | AT&T Inc (T.N; US\$28.77; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Autodesk (ADSK.O; US\$290.23; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Automatic Data Processing Inc (ADP.O; US\$307.95; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | AvePoint Inc (AVPT.O; US\$15.62; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Bezeq Israeli Telecommunication Corp Ltd (BEZQ.TA; NIS6.07; 1; 24 Aug 25; 17:30) | BlackLine Inc (BL.O; US\$53.98; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Booking Holdings (BKNG.O; US\$5720.87; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Box Inc (BOX.N; US\$31.8; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Braze (BRZE.O; US\$26.9; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Broadcom Inc (AVGO.O; US\$294.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Bumble, Inc. Class A (BMBL.O; US\$6.36; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | CarGurus, Inc. (CARG.O; US\$34.18; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Carvana Co. (CVNA.N; US\$357.81; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | CCC Intelligent Solutions (CCCS.O; US\$9.9; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | CDW Corp (CDW.O; US\$167.0; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Celestica (CLS.N; US\$188.92; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Check Point Software

Technologies, Inc. (CHKP.O; US\$190.42; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | CI&T Inc (CINT.N; US\$5.25; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Cisco Systems (CSCO.O; US\$67.32; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Clear Channel Outdoor Holdings Inc (CCO.N; US\$1.28; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Cogent Communications Holdings (CCOI.O; US\$38.38; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Coherent Corp (COHR.K; US\$89.9; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Coinbase Global Inc (COIN.O; US\$319.85; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Comcast Corp (CMCSA.O; US\$34.15; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Corning Incorporated (GLW.N; US\$65.77; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | CoStar Group, Inc. (CSGP.O; US\$91.22; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Cricut Inc (CRCT.O; US\$6.02; 3H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Criteo SA Sponsored ADR (CRTO.O; US\$24.19; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | CrowdStrike Holdings Inc (CRWD.O; US\$420.55; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Cyberark Software Ltd (CYBR.O; US\$441.24; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Datadog (DDOG.O; US\$131.22; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Dayforce Inc (DAY.N; US\$69.2; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Dell Technologies (DELL.N; US\$130.84; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Digital Realty Trust Inc (DLR.N; US\$167.06; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Disco (6146.T; ¥38640.O; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | DoorDash Inc (DASH.O; US\$247.32; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Draftkings Inc (DKNG.O; US\$47.18; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Dropbox Inc (DBX.O; US\$28.82; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Dynatrace (DT.N; US\$49.4; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | eBay Inc. (EBAY.O; US\$99.22; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Elastic NV (ESTC.N; US\$80.06; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Electronic Arts Inc (EA.O; US\$171.4; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Entegris Inc (ENTG.O; US\$87.76; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Equinix Inc. (EQIX.O; US\$786.47; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | eToro Group (ETOR.O; US\$46.61; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | First Advantage Corp (FA.N; US\$17.12; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Fiverr (FVRR.N; US\$23.62; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Flutter Entertainment PLC (FLTRF.L; £221.1; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:30) | FormFactor Inc (FORM.O; US\$29.16; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Fortinet, Inc. (FTNT.O; US\$80.02; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Fujitsu (6702.T; ¥3593.O; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Gannett Co Inc (GCI.N; US\$4.25; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Genius Sports Ltd (GENI.N; US\$12.88; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Global Foundries (GFS.O; US\$34.49; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | GoDaddy, Inc. Class A (GDDY.N; US\$147.07; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Grab Holdings Ltd (GRAB.O; US\$5.13; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE.N; US\$22.45; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Hitachi (6501.T; ¥4124.O; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Hon Hai Precision (2317.TW; NT\$202.5; 1; 22 Aug 25; 13:30) | HP Inc (HPQ.N; US\$27.74; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | IAC Inc. (IAC.O; US\$36.43; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Ibiden (4062.T; ¥7058.O; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Ibotta, Inc. (IBTA.N; US\$27.36; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | IHS Holding Ltd (IHS.N; US\$7.09; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Infineon Technologies (IFXGn.DE; €36.85; 1; 22 Aug 25; 17:30) | Instacart (CART.O; US\$43.37; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Intel Corp (INTC.O; US\$24.8; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Interpublic Group of Companies (IPG.N; US\$27.26; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Intuit Inc. (INTU.O; US\$662.66; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Joint Stock Company Kaspi.kz (KSPI.O; US\$92.54; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | KLA Corp (KLAC.O; US\$870.28; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Klaviyo (KVYO.N; US\$32.77; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Lam Research Corp (LRCX.O; US\$100.08; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Lasertec (6920.T; ¥16045.O; 2; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | LegalZoom.com Inc (LZ.O; US\$10.98; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Lenovo Group (0992.HK; HK\$10.73; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:10) | LG Electronics (066570.KS; W75300.O; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:45) | Liberty Global (LBTYA.O; US\$11.68; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Life360 Inc (LIF.O; US\$90.22; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Logitech International (LOGI.O; US\$103.09; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Lumen (LUMN.N; US\$4.61; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Manhattan Associates Inc (MANH.O; US\$216.26; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Marvell Technology Inc (MRVL.O; US\$73.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Match Group, Inc. (MTCH.O; US\$37.3; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Mediatek (2454.TW; NT\$1365.O; 1; 22 Aug 25; 13:30) | Meta Platforms Inc (META.O; US\$754.79; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Microchip Technology (MCHP.O; US\$69.14; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Microsoft Corp. (MSFT.O; US\$507.23; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Mitsubishi Electric (6503.T; ¥3699.O; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | MKS Inc (MKSI.O; US\$105.25; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | MNTN Inc (MNTN.N; US\$23.0; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Monday.Com Ltd (MNDY.O; US\$177.89; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) |

MongoDB Inc (MDB.O; US\$219.06; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Monolithic Power Systems (MPWR.O; US\$844.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Nasdaq (NDAQ.O; US\$94.75; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | NetApp Inc. (NTAP.N; US\$110.55; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Netflix, Inc (NFLX.O; US\$1204.65; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | New York Times Company (NYT.N; US\$59.79; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | News Corp (NWSA.O; US\$30.5; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Nexstar Media Group, Inc. (NXST.N; US\$207.0; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Nextdoor Holdings Inc (NXDR.N; US\$2.06; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | NICE Ltd (NICE.O; US\$142.5; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Nidec (6594.T; ¥3104.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Nokia OYJ (NOKIA.HE; €3.69; 3; 22 Aug 25; 18:30) | Nova Ltd (NVM.L; US\$252.8; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | NVIDIA Corp (NVDA.O; US\$177.99; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Okta, Inc. (OKTA.O; US\$92.05; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | ON Semiconductor (ON.O; US\$51.85; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | OneStream Inc (OS.O; US\$20.41; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Open Text Corp (OTEX.O; US\$32.63; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Opendoor Technologies Inc (OPEN.O; US\$5.01; 3H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Opera (OPRA.O; US\$16.04; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Oshkosh Corporation (OSK.N; US\$142.13; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Outfront Media Inc (OUT.N; US\$19.18; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Palo Alto Networks, Inc. (PANW.O; US\$185.88; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Panasonic Holdings (6752.T; ¥1544.5; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Paychex Inc (PAYX.O; US\$140.81; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Paycom Software Inc (PAYC.N; US\$233.89; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Pegasystems Inc (PEGA.O; US\$52.93; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Peloton Interactive Inc (PTON.O; US\$7.91; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Pinterest Inc (PINS.N; US\$35.61; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | PTC Inc (PTC.O; US\$215.05; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Qualcomm Inc (QCOM.O; US\$158.01; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Recruit Holdings (6098.T; ¥8764.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Reddit, Inc. (RDDT.N; US\$217.31; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Riot Platforms Inc (RIOT.O; US\$13.22; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Roblox Corp (RBLX.N; US\$117.52; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Roku, Inc. (ROKU.N; US\$94.28; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Roper Technologies Inc (ROP.O; US\$536.84; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Salesforce Inc (CRM.N; US\$248.29; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Samsung Electronics (005930.KS; W71400.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:45) | Sandisk Corp (SNDK.O; US\$46.37; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | SATS (SATS.SI; S\$3.26; 1; 22 Aug 25; 17:06) | SBA Communications Corp (SBAC.O; US\$222.87; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Seagate Technology Holdings PLC (STX.N; US\$159.19; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | ServiceNow, Inc. (NOW.N; US\$886.75; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Shopify Inc (SHOP.O; US\$142.11; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Silicon Laboratories (SLAB.O; US\$145.12; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | SimilarWeb Ltd. (SMWB.N; US\$9.13; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Sirius XM Holdings Inc (SIRI.O; US\$23.45; 3; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | SK Hynix (000660.KS; W251000.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:45) | Snowflake Inc (SNOW.N; US\$196.81; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | SoftBank Group (9984.T; ¥14880.0; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Sony Group (6758.T; ¥4221.0; 2; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Sportradar Group AG (SRAD.O; US\$31.63; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Sprinklr Inc (CXM.N; US\$8.72; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | SPS Commerce Inc (SPSC.O; US\$115.82; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | STMicroelectronics (STMPA.PA; €23.44; 1; 22 Aug 25; 17:30) | Sumco (3436.T; ¥1240.5; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Super Micro Computer, Inc. (SMCI.O; US\$43.88; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Symbolic Inc (SYM.O; US\$46.23; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | T-Mobile US (TMUS.O; US\$251.95; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Take-Two Interactive (TTWO.O; US\$229.03; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Teads Holding Co (TEAD.O; US\$1.94; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | TechWing (089030.KQ; W28850.0; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 15:45) | Teradata Corporation (TDC.N; US\$21.41; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Teradyne Inc (TER.O; US\$115.3; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Texas Instruments Inc (TXN.O; US\$206.06; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | TKO Group Holdings Inc (TKO.N; US\$186.17; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Tokyo Electron (8035.T; ¥20095.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Tokyo Ohka Kogyo (4186.T; ¥4605.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 15:30) | Trade Desk Inc (TTD.O; US\$53.2; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | TripAdvisor (TRIP.O; US\$17.69; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | TSMC (2330.TW; NT\$1135.0; 1; 22 Aug 25; 13:30) | Uber Technologies, Inc. (UBER.N; US\$96.79; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Uniti Group Inc (UNIT.O; US\$6.33; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Unity



Software (U.N; US\$39.16; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Universal Display (OLED.O; US\$144.87; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Varonis Systems Inc (VRNS.O; US\$59.11; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Veeco Instruments (VECO.O; US\$25.25; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Veeva Systems Inc (VEEV.N; US\$290.86; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Verizon Communications Inc (VZ.N; US\$44.44; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Vertex Inc (VERX.N; US\$25.86; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Vivid Seats Inc (SEAT.N; US\$16.9; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Warner Bros Discovery Inc (WBD.O; US\$12.05; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Wayfair (W.N; US\$77.84; 1H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Western Digital (WDC.N; US\$76.97; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | WiseTech Global (WTC.AX; A\$112.59; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Wix (WIX.O; US\$131.82; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Workiva Inc (WK.N; US\$79.98; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Xerox Holdings Corp. (XRX.O; US\$3.85; 2H; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Xometry, Inc. Class A (XMTR.O; US\$49.26; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Ziff Davis, Inc. (ZD.O; US\$38.21; 2; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Zillow Group, Inc. (ZG.O; US\$83.92; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00) | Zscaler (ZS.O; US\$272.52; 1; 22 Aug 25; 16:00)



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## Appendix A-1

### ANALYST CERTIFICATION

The research analysts primarily responsible for the preparation and content of this research report are either (i) designated by "AC" in the author block or (ii) listed in bold alongside content which is attributable to that analyst. If multiple AC analysts are designated in the author block, each analyst is certifying with respect to the entire research report other than (a) content attributable to another AC certifying analyst listed in bold alongside the content and (b) views expressed solely with respect to a specific issuer which are attributable to another AC certifying analyst identified in the price charts or rating history tables for that issuer shown below. Each of these analysts certify, with respect to the sections of the report for which they are responsible: (1) that the views expressed therein accurately reflect their personal views about each issuer and security referenced and were prepared in an independent manner, including with respect to Citigroup Global Markets Inc. and its affiliates; and (2) no part of the research analyst's compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed by that research analyst in this report.

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The Firm has made a market in the publicly traded equity securities of Lenovo Group Ltd on at least one occasion since 1 Jan 2024.

Citi is advisor to The Interpublic Group of Companies Inc. on a pending M&A transaction involving Omnicom Group Incorporated.

A member of Citigroup's Board of Directors is also on the Board of Directors of Analog Devices.

Citi is advisor to Silver Lake Technology Management LLC on a pending M&A transaction involving Intel Corporation.

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A member of Citigroup's Board of Directors is also on the Board of Directors of Hewlett Packard Enterprise Co.

Citi is advisor to T-Mobile US Inc on a pending M&A transaction involving Metronet

A member of the household of Tyler Radke, Analyst, holds a long position in the securities of Autodesk.

Citigroup Global Markets Inc. or its affiliates beneficially owns 1% or more of any class of common equity securities of CI&T Inc, Carvana Co., Coinbase Global Inc, Grab Holdings Ltd, Ibotta, Inc., Intuit Inc., ON Semiconductor, Palo Alto Networks, Inc., Reddit, Inc., Warner Bros Discovery Inc, Wayfair, Western Digital. This position reflects information available as of the prior business day.

Citigroup Global Markets Inc. or its affiliates has a net long position of 0.5% or more of any class of common equity securities of CI&T Inc, Carvana Co., Super Micro Computer, Inc..

Citigroup Global Markets Inc. or its affiliates has a net short position of 0.5% or more of any class of common equity securities of Applovin, Intuit Inc., Palo Alto Networks, Inc., Reddit, Inc., Unity Software.

Citigroup Global Markets Inc. or its affiliates beneficially owns 2.0% or more of any class of common equity securities of CI&T Inc, Carvana Co., Grab Holdings Ltd, Ibotta, Inc., Warner Bros Discovery Inc, Wayfair.

Citigroup Global Markets Inc. or its affiliates beneficially owns 5.0% or more of any class of common equity securities of Reddit, Inc..

Within the past 12 months, Citigroup Global Markets Inc. or its affiliates has acted as manager or co-manager of an offering of securities of ADT, Inc., Advanced Micro Devices, Akamai Technologies, Inc., Alphabet Inc, American Tower Corp, Amphenol Corp, Analog Devices, Apple, Inc., Applovin, Autodesk, Bezeq Israeli Telecommunication Corp Ltd, Booking Holdings, Broadcom Inc, Cisco Systems, Clear Channel Outdoor Holdings Inc, Coinbase Global Inc, Comcast Corp, Cyberark Software Ltd, HP Inc, Hewlett Packard Enterprise, Hon Hai Precision, IHS Holding Ltd, Joint Stock Company Kaspi.kz, Klaviyo, MNTN Inc, Marvell Technology Inc, Match Group, Inc., NetApp Inc., OneStream Inc, Qualcomm Inc, Riot Platforms Inc, SoftBank Group, Sportradar Group AG, Super Micro Computer, Inc., Uber Technologies, Inc., Unity Software, Verizon Communications Inc, Zscaler, eToro Group.

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Inc, Nexstar Media Group, Inc., ON Semiconductor, Okta, Inc., Opendoor Technologies Inc, Palo Alto Networks, Inc., Paychex Inc, Paycom Software Inc, Peloton Interactive Inc, Qualcomm Inc, Reddit, Inc., Roku, Inc., Salesforce Inc, Seagate Technology Holdings PLC, ServiceNow, Inc., Shopify Inc, Snowflake Inc, SoftBank Group, Sony Group, Sprinklr Inc, Super Micro Computer, Inc., T-Mobile US, TKO Group Holdings Inc, TSMC, Take-Two Interactive, Teradyne Inc, Texas Instruments Inc, Uber Technologies, Inc., Uniti Group Inc, Unity Software, Varonis Systems Inc, Verizon Communications Inc, Warner Bros Discovery Inc, Wayfair, Western Digital, Wix, Workiva Inc, Zillow Group, Inc., Zscaler, eBay Inc..

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